Effective without warrant: Causal-normative networks and the social life of status

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Abstract

Social explanation faces a forced choice: treat social statuses as causal patterns with moral labels, or as normative facts whose social uptake is incidental. Neither fits a man effectively hounded for a promise he never made, or a standing that a practice successfully confers while morality rejects it. Status-assignments, I argue, are projectible: observing one licenses defeasible expectations about duty, recognition, and response. Extending Khalidi (2018) on projectible kinds, I model these projections as travelling through a causal-normative network: a typed structure joining causal uptake, recognitional representation, directed status-transition, and non-directed correlative ties within a practice or field. The payoff is an account of how status-assignments can be socially effective, institutionally valid or communally conferred, enforceable or final, recognitionally mistaken, and morally unwarranted in different combinations.

Keywords: social ontology, social status, social kinds, projectibility, causal-normative networks, recognition, misrecognition, conferralism, institutional facts, discrimination.

1 The problem of mixed explanation

Dickens gives the problem its comic legal form in *Bardell v. Pickwick*: a misconstrued exchange becomes an action for breach of promise, then a damages verdict, and then Fleet Prison.[1] Put abstractly, suppose a community or court comes to treat someone as having promised when he hasn't, or as bound by a debt he never incurred.

The treatment is not imaginary: he is asked to pay, blamed when he refuses, distrusted, perhaps shut out. But if the promise was never made, those responses lack the obligation they purport to answer to; the demand has the social force of a warranted demand without its warrant.

Cases of this sort generalize: some social statuses are real in their effects without being morally warranted; some are institutionally valid, or successfully conferred by a communal practice, without being morally warranted. The problem is to explain what can be projected from such assignments –

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[1] In *The Pickwick Papers*, Mrs Bardell's action lays damages at £1,500, the jury awards £750, and Pickwick's refusal to pay carries him toward imprisonment for debt (Dickens, 1837, chaps. 26, 34, 40–41).

what observing the assignment licenses us to defeasibly expect about further status, recognition, and response (Goodman, 1955) – and why those projections don't settle warrant.

Identifying status with treatment makes the wrongly-hounded man indistinguishable from a genuine debtor. Treating status as only a rule-bound normative fact makes the hounding irrelevant. Call this pair of reductions the FORCED CHOICE: model such cases as a causal network with moral labels, or as a normative taxonomy with sociology appended. The forced choice is this paper's opponent.

Both horns have serious backing, and the choice between them structures live debates. Audit studies model discrimination as a causal path from signal to response (Bertrand & Mullainathan, 2004), and critics object that the category so modelled is constituted, not merely causal (Kohler-Hausmann, 2019). Hohfeldian taxonomy states deontic structure exactly and stops before uptake (Hohfeld, 1913). In social ontology the same dialectic runs between rule-based and equilibrium-based accounts of institutions (Hindriks & Guala, 2015), and between what grounds a status fact and what its recognition causes (Ásta, 2018; Epstein, 2015). The question this paper puts to that debate is what single structure lets both halves figure in one explanation without one absorbing the other.

The answer needs both layers: a normative position, and a recognitional-causal path in which recognition can fit that position or fail to, while uptake – the responses that act on the recognition – follows either way. It also needs three families of assessment kept apart: social efficacy, institutional validity or communal conferral, and moral warrant.

Promising is the case I work through, because its LIFE-CYCLE – the recurring sequence a promise runs from creation to discharge – is familiar and its parts are clean: an act creates an obligation, the obligation is recognized and relied on, breach sets off demand and repair, release cancels the obligation. The same shape recurs in consent, in official judgment, and, most systematically, in discrimination, where an assignment that's effective and successfully conferred within its practice hardens into a regime that morality disowns (Section 6). I keep to promising until then.

False promise and discrimination pull the model in different directions. In the false-promise case, the status fails to obtain and recognition answers to nothing. In the discriminatory case, the standing may be genuinely conferred and real while remaining unwarranted. Promising is the clean entry case, not the template for both.

The structure I defend is a CAUSAL-NORMATIVE NETWORK: a directed graph whose nodes are status-relevant items, states, and events, and whose edges are relations of real dependence. The dependence comes in three kinds, displayed by four kinds of edge.

First, CAUSAL PRODUCTION: one event, disposition, procedure, response, record, sanction, or expectation helps produce another. A recognized promise can cause reliance; a judgment can cause enforcement; a recognition state causally drives treatment, and that uptake is where much of the network's efficacy lies.

Second, RECOGNITIONAL REPRESENTATION: a belief, record, or official classification purports to track a status, base, or finding, fitting it, misfitting it, or answering to no status at all. What recognition then drives is causal uptake: demand, sanction, reliance, exclusion. Where a field authorizes an act of recognition to make a status difference, as a court judgment makes an adjudicated liability, the case is compound: recognition plus status-transition.

Third, STATUS-DETERMINATION: field-grounded relations fix whether a status obtains. In the graph, this one kind of dependence appears as two kinds of edge. A directed status-transition edge runs from a performance, rule, status, or transition event to the status it generates, blocks, terminates, defeats, or modifies. An undertaking generates a duty; release terminates it; withdrawal terminates a permission; breach changes what later demand, blame, apology, repair, or excuse would answer to.

A non-directed correlative tie links deontic positions within a single complex. A duty and the claim-right held against the duty-bearer are one jural relation under two descriptions, so from either one reads off the other (Hohfeld, 1913). The tie is correlative, not causal.

These kinds of dependence and the edges that display them describe the structure of the network. They don't yet say whether a status-assignment is valid. Assessment is cross-cutting: an assignment may be effective when recognition and uptake fire, FIELD-VALID when the assignment satisfies institutional rules, successfully conferred when agents with conferral standing in a communal practice impose constraints and enablements, and morally warranted when the standing or treatment has moral authority.

A FIELD here is a normative practice or domain, such as ordinary promising, friendship, contract law, criminal law, or medical ethics, with its own statuses and conditions for generating them. Institutional fields fix offices, procedures, records, and rules. Communal fields fix standing relations without a single authorizing office. Section 7 treats fields as the practice-relative settings in which statuses support projections.

The network is not a replacement for grounding. It is a representation of real dependence relations: the field-relative grounds of statuses, their correlative positions, the recognitions that fit or misfit them, and the uptake that supports social projection from those statuses. In Epstein's vocabulary, a field's FRAME PRINCIPLES specify what grounds each of its statuses, and ANCHORING names the facts that put those frame principles in place (Epstein, 2015); the network explains how the conditions they fix combine with recognition and causal response.

2 Why ordinary causal networks aren't enough

One tempting simplification is to treat causal-normative networks as ordinary causal networks with moral labels added. The best reason to try that comes from Khalidi (2018). Khalidi takes projectibility as the mark of a kind: if something is gold, one can infer its melting point, density, conductivity, and other properties; if something is merely dirt, the label tells us much less. A kind matters for explanation when membership supports such inferences.

For Khalidi, those inferences work because the properties are ordered, not because the same properties merely travel together. Gold's atomic structure explains many of its other properties. A directed causal graph captures that order: change one property in the right way, hold the rest fixed, and another property shifts. The functionless widget fails because its properties form a heap rather than an ordered pattern.

That point should be preserved. Projection needs order. The question is whether all useful order in the moral and institutional domain is causal order.

Promises make the limit visible. Suppose Nora promises to return a borrowed book on Friday. From the promise we can infer several things: Owen has a claim, Nora owes performance, Owen may rely, breach may license demand or apology. Some of those inferences are causal projections. When Nora's words are recognized as a promise, they may cause Owen not to buy another copy. But the duty and the claim-right aren't cause and effect; they are the same promissory relation viewed from two sides, so the step from one to the other is a read-off, not a prediction.

Release makes the point again. If Owen releases Nora on Thursday, the same Friday non-return no longer counts as a breach. The release needn't cause the non-return, the book, or Nora's later conduct. It changes the field conditions under which the later non-performance has breach status. That dependence is directed status-determination, since release defeats the duty whose violation would make non-return a breach. It supports projection from release to the absence of liability or repair, but it isn't causal production in Khalidi's sense.

Consent has the same shape. A patient signs a consent form before a procedure. The signed form may causally move many things: a nurse updates the chart, the surgeon schedules the room, the anaesthetist prepares the drugs. But the permission relation is not just that causal chain. If the patient withdraws consent before the procedure, the same incision changes status. The incision is no longer permitted treatment but a wrong. The withdrawal orders the later facts, because withdrawal changes what the later act is, even if some staff do not hear about it and the causal machinery keeps moving.

In what sense, then, are promises, consents, and judgments projectible? Not because *promise* entails its consequences as a matter of definition. The projectibility claim concerns defeasible expectations: that an undertaking generated a duty (defeated by joke, coercion, or want of standing), that recognition and reliance will follow (defeated by inattention or distrust), that breach will draw demand, apology, or repair (defeated by release or excuse).

These are inductive licences of the kind Khalidi's account trades in, not deductive consequences of a label. The one strict inference in the set, from duty to correlative claim-right, is a read-off, and Section 4 sets it apart from projection proper.

The extension to Khalidi is narrow. Projectibility still requires order. Khalidi himself treats it as a live possibility that fundamental physics tracks structural real patterns while the special sciences track causal ones (Khalidi, 2013, pp. 211–212). The moral and institutional cases make a parallel but more local point: some of their order is carried by status-determination and recognitional links rather than by causal mechanisms alone. Section 4 builds that typed network; the present point is only that ordinary causal networks are too narrow, not that order was the wrong demand.

3 Why normative taxonomies aren't enough

The opposite simplification keeps the normative structure and strips away the causal uptake. That is tempting too. Analytic jurisprudence has mapped much of the structure: Hohfeld (1913) sorts deontic positions into correlatives and opposites, claim and duty, power and liability. A taxonomy in this style can say that a promise generates an obligation, consent a permission, release a termination, and breach a license to complain.

That taxonomy is indispensable, but it is not yet an explanation of projection in practice. Suppose Nora fails to return the book. The taxonomy says she has breached and that Owen may complain. It doesn't say whether Owen notices, whether the complaint is taken up, whether Nora apologizes or offers an excuse, whether repair follows, or whether trust changes between them.

Those further regularities are what make promise-breaking projectible as a social kind. Breach has a recognizable place in a life-cycle: registration, demand, excuse or apology, repair or sanction, revised trust. The status starts the sequence, but the sequence runs through recognition and causal uptake.

Official judgment makes the same point in a more formal register. A taxonomy can say, in broad terms, that a judgment creates an adjudicated liability, a final or preclusive position, or a remedial power (American Law Institute, 1982, §§ 17–19, 24, 27). But what makes judgment projectible in practice is also the file, the docket entry, the enforcement routine, the attorney's letter, the threat of contempt, and the debtor's changed bargaining position. Those are not further deontic implications written into the word *judgment*; they are the ordinary uptake by which a legal status becomes socially and institutionally effective.

This is why a purely normative taxonomy is too thin. A status no one could recognize, rely on, or enforce would support no social projection at all. It would still be a status, but it would not explain the patterned responses by which promise-breaking, consent withdrawal, judgment, or discriminatory ascription become stable objects of expectation.

The two horns of the forced choice now fail from opposite sides. Causal order alone was too narrow; normative order alone is too thin. The explanatory unit is neither causal regularity nor normative status by itself, but a normative position coupled to causal uptake. Section 6 turns to the cases in which the two come apart.

4 The typed-edge model

If the explanatory unit is a normative position coupled to causal uptake, the graph has to show both parts. In the promise case it has to show the obligation and claim-right; otherwise the wrongness of demand is lost. It also has to show uptake, reliance, demand, and repair; otherwise the promise has no social life.

I keep Khalidi's picture of a kind as a highly connected node in a directed graph (Khalidi, 2018), but I let the edges differ in type. The vertices are status-relevant items, states, and events; the edges are typed relations of real dependence.[2]

The graph is a representation of real dependence relations, not a further social object or an added ground of the statuses it represents. Representation in this sense is the modeller's relation to the world; it is distinct from the recognitional edges inside the graph, which mark one social item, a belief or record, representing a status. Nora's duty is grounded by her undertaking under the rules of the relevant field; Owen's claim-right is the correlative position; Owen's reliance is an ordinary causal effect; his recognition is a representation of the duty. The realism here is modest but not merely notational: causal production, field-grounded status-determination, Hohfeldian correlativity, and recognitional representation differ in their counterfactual behaviour. The network displays those relations together so that projections across them can be tracked.

This means that a status-transition edge is not an extra metaphysical producer of the status. It is a directed status-determination edge: under the field's frame principles, the source item is among the grounds, defeaters, or status-altering conditions for the target status. The network represents that field-grounded relation; it does not replace the grounding story.

The strongest rival is a division of labour: use grounding and anchoring to explain the status, then use causal mechanisms to explain uptake. That rival is right that the graph does not replace grounding and anchoring. It is wrong if it treats the relevant relations as explanatorily separable ledgers whose combination leaves nothing further to display.

[2] Formally, this is a typed-edge relational structure: node labels for kinds, edge labels for dependence types, and well-formed configurations. Pullum and Rogers (2008) use a similar node/edge format for English syntax; the analogy only marks the intended level of abstraction. Pullum and Scholz (2001) set out the model-theoretic stance.

What remains is the assignment's PROJECTION PROFILE: which inferences it supports, along which edges, with which defeaters. The same assignment can support a transition inference, a correlative read-off, a recognition inference, and an uptake inference, while failing at a different assessment point.

A release cancels the duty even if demand continues. A mistaken verdict can make enforcement and preclusion projectible without making the underlying finding true. A discriminatory standing can be successfully conferred and predict credibility loss, routing, sanction risk, and anticipatory adjustment while remaining morally unwarranted. Separate ledgers can list the facts; the diagnostic pattern remains implicit: where projection travels, where it changes edge type, and where warrant fails to follow.

The discrimination case shows the gain. A false recognition and a wrongful conferral can both be effective without warrant. If the only ledgers are grounding and causation, that common structure is easy to state and the difference is easy to miss.

The false-recognition case is locally correctable: remove the mistaken recognition, and the demand loses the status it purported to answer to. The wrongful-conferral case is recursive: earlier uptake helps fix the standing to which later recognition responds. The network earns its keep by making that difference part of the projection profile rather than an after-the-fact comparison between two explanations.

To draw such a graph, start with the explanatory question. If the question is why Owen may demand performance, the duty and claim-right matter. If the question is why Nora is shunned despite never promising, the false recognition and its causal uptake matter. If the question is why a court order leads to enforcement, the judgment and the enforcement machinery matter.

The node types are simple. Performances include utterances, signed documents, actions, and omissions. Statuses include obligation, permission, power, liability, immunity, and standing. Status-transition sources include undertaking, authorization, release, withdrawal, breach, and defeat. Recognition states include belief, record, and official classification. Uptake and response states include reliance, demand, blame, resentment, apology, repair, sanction, exclusion, and trust revision.

The carrying cases fill those slots in familiar ways. In a promise, the undertaking generates a duty; recognition by the promisee or audience helps drive reliance, demand, apology, repair, and trust revision. In consent, giving or withdrawing consent generates or terminates a permission, while recognition determines whether others proceed, stop, complain, or apologize. In a judgment, the court's act is both an official recognition and a status-altering event, with records, enforcement, and remedies downstream. In discrimination, a signal or classification drives recognition and downstream uptake, and stabilized uptake can help confer a degraded standing.

Consider the promise graph as a drawing exercise. Nora's utterance goes in because it can generate the duty and become the object of recognition. The duty goes in because it is what Owen's demand purports to answer to. Owen's recognition goes in because reliance, demand, and repair usually pass through his recognition of the promise.

The weather, Nora's mood, and the room's acoustics stay out unless they matter to the explanatory question. Not every fact in the room gets a vertex. If the question is only why Owen relied, acoustics may matter; if the question is whether Nora owed performance, they usually do not.

Now change the case. Suppose Nora never promised, but Owen misheard a joke as an undertaking. The graph should not smuggle in a duty node to make sense of Owen's anger. Outrage is not an admission rule. It should show Owen's recognition state and its causal downstream: demand, blame, distrust. The absent duty is part of the explanation, because it is why the demand misfires. A purely causal graph would see only Owen's anger; a purely normative taxonomy would see only the absence of duty. The mixed graph shows both.

The admission rule is practical: add a node only if leaving it out would make the explanation worse. A performance enters when it can generate, alter, defeat, or causally move a status, recognition, or response. A status enters when the field's conditions make it obtain. If the dispute is whether the status obtains, as with Pickwick's alleged promise, the graph may mark the candidate as absent rather than draw it as an ordinary status node.

The same discipline applies to edges. Draw a causal edge only where one item helps produce another. Draw a status-transition edge only where a performance, rule, status, or transition event generates, terminates, blocks, defeats, or modifies a status. Draw a correlative tie only where two positions are one relation under two descriptions. Draw a recognitional edge only where recognition fits an actual status node.

That last rule matters. In a false-promise case, demand doesn't prove a duty. The graph should show a recognition node with live causal uptake and no fitting recognitional edge to an actual duty. Nor should moral warrant appear as a further status node that causes legitimacy; warrant is an assessment of the assignment. And the duty–claim-right tie should not be replaced with a causal arrow, since correlatives are not two states linked by a mechanism.

The network's three kinds of dependence are displayed by four kinds of edge: causal edges, recognitional edges, status-transition edges, and non-directed correlative ties among deontic positions. Two further notions sit just outside the inventory. One is AUTHORIZED RECOGNITION, the judgment case: a court records a liability and, because the field authorizes the court to do so, creates a new procedural status.

The other is PROJECTION: using one point in the network to make defeasible inferences about what else should hold or what will happen next. I restrict the term to inferences that further facts could defeat. The correlative tie licenses something stricter, a READ-OFF: given the duty, the claim-right is not a further expectation but the same relation redescribed. Read-offs are exact and indefeasible, so they are not projections, and the paper's projectibility claims never rest on them alone.

Counterfactual probes help reveal the projection profile, but they do not supply a one-step classifier for every edge. I reserve INTERVENTION in the strict Woodwardian sense for causal edges. Woodward (2003) counts a relation as causal when some possible intervention on the first variable changes the second while everything else is held fixed, and the change reaches the second only through the first (Woodward, 2015).

A causal edge passes this test in the ordinary way: intervene on the recognition state and reliance shifts, intervene on the judgment and enforcement may follow. Khalidi already reads his own causal edges this way (Khalidi, 2018), which is why typing the edges extends his picture rather than breaking with it.

A correlative tie fails the test in a way that helps mark its type. A duty and its correlative claim-right aren't two states linked by a mechanism; they're one jural relation under two descriptions (Hohfeld, 1913). No intervention changes the duty while holding the claim-right fixed, because changing the one just is changing the other: the change doesn't reach the claim-right only through the duty, it lands on both at once. By Woodward's own criterion the tie isn't causal, and that failure is what marks it as correlative rather than causal.

Status-transition cases behave differently. Release, withdrawal, undertaking, and judgment alter the field conditions under which a status obtains. Their dependence is directed, but it is directed status-determination rather than causal production: release the promisor and the same non-performance is no longer a breach. Hohfeldian correlatives are the limiting non-directed case, because duty and claim-right are not successive statuses but one jural relation under two descriptions.

The positive mark of status-determination is determination rather than production. Undertakings, releases, withdrawals, and judgments do not push later behaviour along a mechanism in the way recognition pushes reliance or enforcement. They fix, defeat, or alter whether a status obtains under the field's frame principles. Some cases, such as duty and claim-right, also fail Woodward's distinctness condition outright. Others, such as undertaking to duty, may involve distinct relata. The kind is unified not by one Woodwardian failure mode but by its role in fixing status rather than producing uptake.

A recognitional edge connects an actual status node to a recognition node that fits it. A belief, record, or classification, itself driven by signals and cues along causal edges, may also misfit or answer to no status at all. In those failed cases the recognition node remains, with its outgoing causal edges, but the fitting recognitional edge is absent or failed. That gap is what the *mis-* in misrecognition marks.

One occurrence can also enter more than one relation. The same utterance *I'll do it* may generate a duty if made under the right conditions, become the object of later recognition, and support reliance through that recognition. The same court order can be evidence in one setting, an operative change in another, and the cause of enforcement in a third. A racialized name on a resume is different again: it is not the status it signals, but a cue that causally moves recognition, which then moves callback behavior.

When representation succeeds, recognition tracks the status (Figure 1). Fit is separate from downstream uptake: treatment, demand, sanction, reliance, and exclusion follow causal paths. Those paths are where the normative layer re-enters social explanation.

Sbisà (2023) describes illocutionary acts as assigning or cancelling deontic-modal predicates; on the present model, such an act appears as a performance feeding a status-transition edge.

Figure 1 renders a promise as a small typed-edge network, with the four edge types that recur across the carrying cases.

Two conditions keep such a graph from sliding back into a mere list of properties. First, inference has to respect edge type. The inferential ledger is mixed: causal edges license projections of uptake or response; status-transition edges license projections from performances or rules to generated, defeated, or altered statuses; recognitional edges license projections about tracking, misfitting, and downstream uptake; correlative ties license only read-offs, redescriptions rather than projections.

Second, a status that is meant to explain a SOCIAL CASCADE – the run of responses in which one agent's uptake becomes the next agent's cue: demand, enforcement, apology, exclusion, repair – has to be reachable by response states through recognition and causal uptake. A status can obtain without being noticed, but it explains projectible demand, enforcement, apology, exclusion, or repair only where the field supplies pathways by which agents can track or respond to it.

Table 1 gives the compact ledger for the four carrying cases. It is not a list of case outcomes; it is a guide to what kind of inference each source item supports, and where that inference can fail.

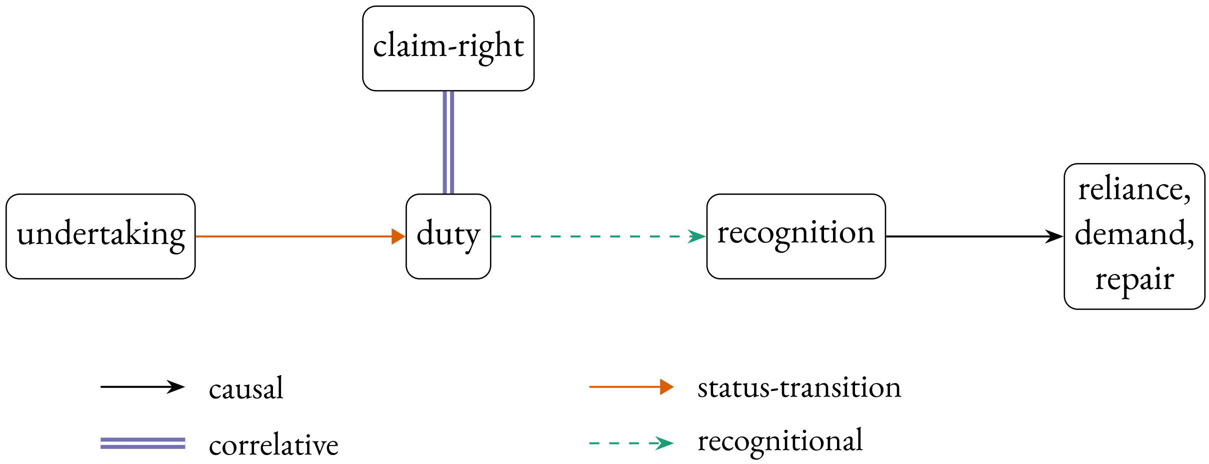

Figure 1: A promise as a causal-normative network. The undertaking generates the duty (a status-transition); the duty carries its correlative claim-right (a correlative tie, drawn without an arrowhead, since correlatives are one relation under two descriptions, not a directed cause); the duty is tracked by recognition, which causally drives reliance, demand, and repair. The recognitional edge is drawn from the duty node for simplicity: recognition may track the duty–claim-right complex under either description. In failed cases the recognition node remains without a fitting edge (Section 4). The four edge types are keyed below the graph.

Case and field	Source item	Main edge	Projection or read-off	Defeater or limit
Promise, ordinary promising	Undertaking	Status-transition; correlative	Duty (claim-right by read-off); reliance, demand, apology, or repair if recognized	Joke, coercion, release, or lack of authority to bind
Consent, medical ethics	Consent or withdrawal	Status-transition; recognition-to-uptake	Permission, its lapse, charting, stopping, complaint, or apology	Incapacity, defective disclosure, withdrawal, emergency, or missed recognition
Judgment, law	Court judgment	Authorized recognition: recognition plus status-transition	Adjudicated status, record, finality or preclusion, remedial and enforcement position (American Law Institute, 1982, §§ 17–19, 24, 27)	Lack of jurisdiction, appeal, vacatur, procedural defect, or moral error
Discrimination, communal practice	Signal or ascription plus empowered uptake	Causal recognition path; communal conferral	Lowered credibility, restricted options, risk, routing, anticipatory adjustment	Weak uptake, counter-practice, lack of conferral standing, or no durable position

Table 1: A compact projection ledger. Each row gives the field, the source item from which projection starts, the main edge type, the target of projection (with read-offs marked), and the defeaters or limits that keep projection from becoming moral warrant.

With those conditions in place the graph carries order in Khalidi's sense, projection along directed edges, while generalizing what that order is: not causal dependence throughout, but causal, recognitional, and status-determination routes. The non-directed correlative tie is the limiting case, licensing read-offs rather than projections.

All these nodes and edges are field-indexed. Contract law, medical ethics, friendship, and discriminatory practices fix different repertoires, authorities, records, responses, and defeaters; Section 7 returns to the field parameter.

5 Coupling and counterfactual patterns

The easiest way to see the coupling is to ask simple what-if questions. What if Owen releases Nora? What if Owen mistakenly believes Nora promised? What if a court enters judgment? Each change moves a different part of the graph, and the pattern tells us which kind of edge is doing the work. I call these COUNTERFACTUAL PATTERNS. I reserve intervention for the genuinely causal edges, where Woodward's apparatus applies directly.

The first what-if changes a status or the rule behind it. Release the promisor and later nonperformance is no longer a breach; the demand, blame, and repair that breach would license lapse because the breach status is gone. Withdraw consent and the same act of touching changes from permitted to wrongful. Speak without standing and the same words fail to bind; an official's words and a bystander's words don't have the same status effects. These are the status-altering acts the normative-powers literature describes (Owens, 2012; Raz, 2022).

Call that a STATUS-RULE PATTERN. The status node changes first in the order of explanation, and uptake follows because agents now have a different status to recognize or answer to. The audience may be psychologically unchanged at the first moment: Owen may still expect the book, the doctor may still prepare the procedure, the clerk may still open the file. What has changed is what their responses would now be responses to. The pattern licenses projection from release, withdrawal, or authorization to changed duty, permission, liability, or remedial position even when uptake lags.

The consent example is useful because the surface behavior can remain almost unchanged. A clinician reaches for the same instrument, at the same time, for the same medical reason. Before withdrawal, the permission licenses that act. After withdrawal, the same act of touching is no longer licensed. If the clinician has not heard the withdrawal, her recognition node may still represent the old permission, and her action may continue along the old causal path. The status-rule pattern and the recognition pattern come apart in one ordinary case.

The second what-if changes recognition while the status stays put. Suppose Nora never promised, but Owen and the audience believe she did. There is no promise-duty node for recognition to fit, but the false recognition node can still drive demand, blame, and loss of trust. Suppose consent has been withdrawn but the withdrawal is not registered. The permission has lapsed, but the old response path may keep running.

Call this a RECOGNITION PATTERN. The recognition node may fit the status, misfit it, or answer to no status at all. Either way, the causal edge leaving the recognition node can fire.

In hiring, changing the employer's belief about an applicant's gender changes the recognition node and the causal edge from recognition to callback while leaving the applicant and the moral facts unchanged. Woodward's own reading of *being a woman causes hiring discrimination* relocates the cause to the employer's beliefs about the applicant's gender (Woodward, 2015): a recognition pattern in the present sense, projecting efficacy without projecting warrant.

The third what-if is the compound case. A judgment records, finds, or accepts a status, but the field also gives the judgment a power to change the parties' statuses. Before judgment, the alleged liability may be disputed. After judgment, the field may treat the parties as occupying a new procedural or remedial position even where the court is mistaken: a record, enforceability, finality or preclusion, or remedial power (American Law Institute, 1982, §§ 17–19, 24, 27).

Contract law has parallel discharge devices, such as accord and satisfaction or a contract not to sue, that alter the obligation itself even if demand continues (American Law Institute, 1981, §§ 281, 285).

This is AUTHORIZED RECOGNITION. Authorized recognition is not a fifth primitive. The same judgment-node occupies two roles: recognition, because the judgment records or finds; transition, because the field authorizes that recognition to make a status difference. The pattern projects field-valid procedural consequences from the authorized act without projecting moral warrant or truth of the underlying finding.

Pickwick again shows why the compound matters. The alleged proposal does not by itself create the promised obligation. But the verdict creates an adjudicated liability within the procedure of the court. That position can be entered in a record, treated as settled for procedural purposes, and routed into remedial or enforcement machinery. One mistake is to say that the judgment merely recognizes a liability already there. Another is to say that the judgment is just a cause of imprisonment. It is both recognition and status-transition: a finding that the field treats as operative.

Causal-inference practice grades its questions: association asks what accompanies what, intervention asks what would follow if a node were set by fiat, and counterfactuals ask what would have held had things gone otherwise (Pearl, 2009). The what-if patterns above are questions of the second and third grades, but only the causal edges answer to the do-operator; on transition and correlative structure, the answers are fixed by the field's rules rather than by mechanisms.

These patterns depend on a separability assumption. We have to be able, at least in explanation, to change one node or edge while holding the adjacent structure fixed. Woodward calls this MODULARITY: mechanisms are separately disruptable in principle (Woodward, 2003). The condition is not trivial. In an actual field, rules, records, and uptake often move together, which is why the patterns are explanatory probes rather than field experiments.

If a public release also changes belief, the graph records both a status-rule change and a causal update in recognition. The separability claim is that those routes can be distinguished in explanation, not that fields usually isolate them in practice.

That qualification matters most in communal-conferral fields. In promising, consent, and formal judgment, one can often hold status fixed while varying recognition, or hold recognition fixed while varying status. In conferralist cases, enough change in recognition and uptake can itself change the standing. The framework predicts partial separability there: the signal-recognition-response pathway can be probed before it hardens into a position, but the entrenched position is partly constituted by the stabilized pathway.

Correlative ties fail the separability condition outright. One can't change a duty while holding the correlative claim-right fixed, since the two are one relation under two descriptions. In clean cases, the status-rule and recognition contrasts can still be drawn. Release the promisor and the obligation lapses while the audience's belief can remain; change an employer's belief while the applicant's status remains. The modularity contrast helps locate causal routes and the limiting correlative cases; the remaining work is done by the field-grounded status-determination relation itself.

I set aside a pure causal intervention, such as severing an uptake mechanism so the letter never arrives, because both reductive views already grant it. It can't distinguish the reductive views from the coupled account. A missed letter is too easy; the problem is a live demand with no warrant.

The status-rule and recognition patterns expose the mistake in the forced choice. The recognition reduction predicts that enough uptake turns the recognition node into the status node. The normative reduction keeps the status node but treats misfiring recognition and its causal effects as noise. The two probes show why both are wrong: demand and duty can vary separately.

The point carries across the cases. A causal graph with moral labels can't explain release, because labels don't change breach status. A normative taxonomy with sociology appended can't explain false uptake, because it has nowhere to put efficacy without warrant. The coupled, typed structure is needed because it predicts which part of the case moves and which part holds fixed.

An interventionist objection presses from the other direction. Why not drop the network label and disambiguate everything into manipulations of beliefs, records, and behavior? The reply turns on Woodward's own view that interventionism is methodology, not ontology (Woodward, 2015). It clarifies causal claims by tying them to hypothetical experiments; it doesn't say that every relation clarified in that way is causal.

The promise case shows the difference. Release the promisor and the obligation node lapses, even if the audience keeps believing that the promisor owes performance. Change the audience's belief instead, and demand or blame may move while the duty does not. Both probes need the status node: without it, one can record who demanded what, but not whether the demand fitted an obligation.

The same point holds for discrimination. If a correspondence study changes the employer's belief, it identifies a causal path from signal to recognition to callback. It doesn't settle whether the belief fits the applicant's social status, or whether the status assignment has warrant. The interventionist disambiguation is useful, but it marks rather than removes the place where a normative edge is needed.

6 Misrecognition as the diagnostic case

Misrecognition is the sharpest diagnostic because it asks a plain question: what should we say when people treat someone as bound, liable, authorized, dangerous, or disqualified, and that treatment is wrong? A recognition-only account says the treatment makes the status. A purely normative account says the treatment is noise around the real status. Neither answer fits Pickwick, who is effectively hounded as a promisor without having made the promise.

The network separates four questions. Is the assignment socially effective? That is a question about uptake: do people rely, demand, enforce, exclude, record, or sanction? Is it institutionally field-valid? That is a question about the right party, office, procedure, form, record, rule, or authority. Is it successfully conferred in a communal practice? That is a question about conferral standing in context and imposed constraints and enablements. Is it morally warranted? That is a question about whether the standing or treatment has moral authority rather than imposing unjust constraint.

I do not give a first-order theory of moral warrant here. The narrower claim is that, whatever supplies the moral standard, efficacy, field-validity, and successful conferral do not supply it by themselves.

Nor is moral warrant just field-validity in a moral field. A field, as I use the term, supplies a status repertoire, standing relations, recognizable moves, records or uptake routes, and defeaters that make projections usable inside a practice. Moral warrant is the assessment standpoint from which those field rules and conferrals are themselves answerable.

That standpoint may itself be theorized in different moral vocabularies; the present framework only requires that it not be reduced to efficacy or successful conferral. There may be moral practices and moral recognition, but the warrant column asks whether a field's assignment has authority, not whether it satisfies another conferral rule.

Table 2 turns those questions into a checklist for status-assignments. Some columns are basic families of assessment; others are refinements needed for institutional, procedural, and recognitional cases. They often travel together in ordinary cases, but none carries the others with it.

Assessment	Question	Does not settle
Social efficacy	Do recognition and uptake produce reliance, demand, enforcement, exclusion, records, or sanction?	Whether the status obtains or is warranted
Institutional field-validity	Did the right office, procedure, form, record, rule, or authority assign the status?	Truth, justice, or current recognition
Communal successful conferral	Did agents with conferral standing in context place someone under constraints and enablements?	Moral authority or institutional legality
Recognitional fit	Does the belief, record, or classification track the status, base, or finding it purports to track?	Efficacy, validity, or warrant
Enforceability or finality	Can the field's machinery act on the assignment, or treat it as settled for procedural purposes?	Moral warrant or underlying truth
Moral warrant	Does the standing or treatment have moral authority and avoid unjust constraint?	Social efficacy or field-validity

Table 2: Assessment columns for status-assignments. The columns often travel together, but none entails the others.

In a straightforward case, the columns line up. A genuine promise may be recognized, valid in the relevant practice, and morally binding. But the columns can also come apart. A crowd may demand performance where no promise was made. A court may impose an adjudicated liability by a valid procedure on a mistaken record. An unjust practice may successfully confer a standing while morality rejects the standing itself.

It helps to keep the columns separate. In the false-promise case, social efficacy is present if people demand and blame, but field-validity and moral warrant are absent if no undertaking occurred. In the mistaken-judgment case, efficacy is present and legal field-validity may also be present, even though the underlying finding is wrong. In the discrimination case, a community may confer a degraded standing that is socially real and stabilized by the practice, while the moral-warrant column remains empty.

Four failure modes follow. False recognition has uptake without field-validity or moral warrant; Pickwick's alleged promise is the comic case. Wrongful institutional validity has field rules assigning a status without moral warrant. Wrongful communal conferral has conferral standing without moral authority. Suppressed entitlement has a moral basis that the field refuses to register.

In false recognition, uptake outruns status. In wrongful institutional validity, field-validity outruns warrant. In wrongful communal conferral, conferral outruns authority. In suppressed entitlement, warrant outruns recognition.

Pickwick is useful because it keeps the first failure mode clean. Until judgment enters, there is no promised obligation for recognition to fit. The verdict then changes the case: it is an authorized recognition that creates a new legal liability. The episode shows efficacy without the promised obligation, but it does not yet show the regime structure of wrongful conferral.

Suppressed entitlement is the mirror image. A friend may be owed an apology, a patient may have withdrawn consent, or a party may have a procedural entitlement, while the local practice refuses to record the claim, routes around it, or treats assertion as troublemaking. The status is not created by recognition; recognition is missing where the status should be tracked.

Regime cases require more than one mistaken uptake. A person wrongly believed to have promised faces a local failure: demand, blame, and distrust may be real, but the error can in principle be corrected by showing that no promise was made. A durable discriminatory practice is different. It repeats the ascription, routes it through records and expectations, and gives people real constraints and enablements under that description.

Ásta's conferralist account helps specify that second structure. A social status is conferred on a person because agents with conferral standing in a context take them to have some base property, whether or not they actually have it, and impose real constraints and enablements on what they may do (Ásta, 2018). The ascribed standing is not a mere belief. It is a social position with teeth.

Conferralism might seem to collapse the distinction I need. If the status just is what gets conferred, then enough recognition constitutes the status. But the collapse is avoided once the assessment questions are separated. Conferral can make a communal status real and effective without making it morally warranted. A discriminatory standing can be successfully conferred, stabilized by its practice, and morally indefensible at the same time.

Jenkins (2020, 2023) calls this family of wrongs ontic injustice: a person is wronged by being socially constructed as a member of a social kind when that construction places them under wrongful constraints and enablements.

On the taxonomy used here, ontic injustice spans wrongful institutional validity and wrongful communal conferral: the status may be institutionally valid without warrant, or it may be communally conferred without moral authority. Jenkins gives the moral-ontological diagnosis; the typed-edge account adds the projection map by separating recognitional classification, causal uptake, status-determination, field-validity or successful conferral, and moral warrant. That separation lets these wrongs be distinguished from false recognition and suppressed entitlement.

Some oppression works through this route: morally indefensible status-ascriptions become socially effective, and sometimes institutionally valid or successfully conferred, along durable recognition and response pathways. Not all oppression does. Much is material, distributive, or coercive rather than recognitional, the pressure the redistribution-versus-recognition debate brings to bear (Fraser & Honneth, 2003). Stabilized wrongful conferral is only the case this account is built to diagnose.

Material and distributive structures are not therefore invisible to the network. They can enter as causal constraints, resources, built environments, or enforcement routines. What the present section adds is narrower: when those pathways also impose a standing, the explanation needs a status node as well as causal paths to harm.

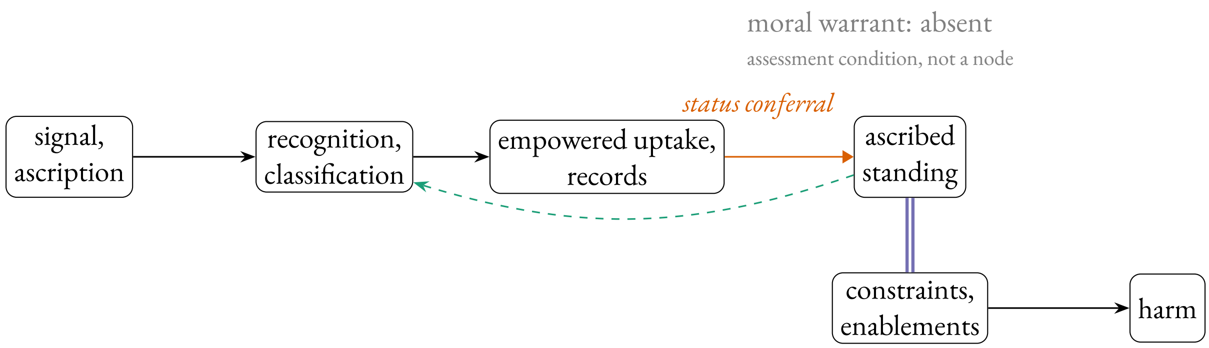

Figure 2: Wrongful conferral. A signal or ascription moves recognition, and recognition moves structurally empowered uptake and records. The orange edge marks status-conferral: agents with conferral standing can stabilize that uptake and confer an ascribed standing. The green dashed edge marks later recognition tracking the standing, not the conferral itself. Moral warrant, not the standing, is absent (grey annotation). This is not the false-promise case, where recognition fails to fit an absent status. Edge styles as in Figure 1.

Read Figure 2 from left to right. A signal or ascription moves recognition, and recognition moves structurally empowered uptake and records. When that uptake becomes a durable practice of records, expectations, sanctions, and anticipatory adjustment, it can help confer a standing. The standing node is not a hidden essence behind those patterns. It marks the position that becomes available for projection once the constraints and enablements stabilize. The standing is constituted by constraints and enablements, which project altered options, credibility, risk, authority, access, self-regulation, and downstream harm.

The conferring agents are those whose uptake is structurally empowered in that context: gatekeepers, officials, employers, teachers, clinicians, peers, or a dominant local audience. The base or ascription is the property they take the person to have. The conferred status is a role-like standing in that setting rather than the base property itself: lowered credibility, suspected dangerousness, reduced authority, or disfavoured applicant standing.

Discrimination, where it runs through conferred standing, is the regime case for the present account. The efficacy is measurable, if crudely. In the correspondence study by Bertrand and Mullainathan (2004, pp. 997–998), otherwise-matched resumes with White-sounding names drew about 50% more callbacks than those with African-American-sounding names (9.65% against 6.45%), and Ayres (1991) found parallel differential treatment in retail car negotiations.

These studies show patterned uptake: a name or other raced signifier sends a causal edge to a recognition node, and that recognition node sends causal edges to callbacks, prices, warnings, searches, or other outcomes. They evidence a signal-recognition-response pathway; they do not by themselves establish a degraded standing. A normative taxonomy with no place for this efficacy can't describe what's happening.

The studies do not manipulate race itself. As Weinberger (2022) observes, they manipulate a signal for race: the name matters because it reliably tracks race, and the experiment varies the signal to mimic what it would be were the candidate of another race, leaving the candidate's race untouched. That is a localized causal test of the signal-recognition-response pathway. It does not make race an ordinary manipulable cause, and it does not reduce race to its signals.

Detection is still not an account of discrimination. Kohler-Hausmann (2019) is right that a signal test can show race made a difference without saying what race is or why discriminating on it is wrong. Hu (forthcoming) presses further: deciding which differences between two candidates constitute rather than confound the effect of race already takes a normative stand, so even the measurement presupposes the normative layer.

What turns biased uptake into conferred standing is entrenchment under agents with conferral standing in that context. A single misfiring is false recognition. A stable recognition-response pathway is different. When the pathway is repeated, recorded, expected, and treated as a guide for action, the entrenched pathway shapes what one may do, where, with what credibility, and at what risk. That imposed structure, not the bare frequency of mistreatment, is the degraded standing (Ásta, 2018).

The contrast is between an episode and a position. A single employer's biased callback decision is an episode of differential treatment. It may be wrongful, and it may reveal a causal pathway from signal to recognition to response. A standing emerges when decisions of that sort become mutually reinforcing: employers expect other employers to read the signal the same way, applicants adjust their applications in anticipation, institutions record and route outcomes accordingly, and the burden becomes part of what one has to navigate. The graph then has a stable ascribed-standing node, not just repeated arrows from signal to harm.

The difference is not frequency by itself. Repeated false recognitions remain false recognition if each episode has to do the whole explanatory work again: one employer misreads a signal, one audience misclassifies a speaker, one official acts on a mistake.

A position emerges when earlier uptake becomes part of the practical background for later uptake. Records travel, audiences anticipate one another, gatekeepers treat the ascription as action-guiding, targets adjust before any new decision is made, and sanctions or risks attach to occupying the ascribed place. At that point the pathway is recursive: recognition causes treatment, treatment stabilizes expectations and records, and those stabilized expectations and records help fix the standing to which later recognition responds.

This is why separability is stage-relative. At the episode stage, one can probe the pathway from signal to recognition to response while holding standing fixed or absent. At the regime stage, that probe no longer cleanly separates standing from uptake, because the stabilized pathway has become one of the standing's conferral conditions.

The loss of clean separability is not a collapse of the distinction between false recognition and wrongful conferral. It is the mark that the case has moved from an episode to a position. The boundary is vague, but it is not unconstrained: a standing node is warranted only when the practice supports projections that no single episode supports, such as altered options, anticipated risk, lowered credibility, institutional routing, and self-adjustment across contexts.

There is no sharp threshold at which episodes become a position. The standing node marks a cluster stabilized by the mechanisms already named: records, anticipatory adjustment, mutual expectation, sanction, routing, and repeated recognition by agents with conferral standing. Borderline cases are expected. Their vagueness is the ordinary vagueness of cluster kinds, not a missing necessary and sufficient condition.

The discrimination this account captures is entrenched wrongful conferral: recognitional and causal paths become entrenched through those mechanisms and support projection from ascription to degraded standing. The field may sustain that standing; morality rejects it. Other discrimination need not run through conferred standing. Resource allocation, exclusionary design, and statistical sorting can wrong without conferring a degraded status. The present account claims only the conferral-based cases.

That limit matters. Marques (2017, pp. 19–23) argues that causal social construction remains politically relevant even where constitutive construction is granted or unsettled. The graph should keep ordinary causal routes to harm visible alongside the narrower conferral pattern.

The route to wrongful conferral begins with the recognition pattern of Section 5. At the audit-study stage, one can vary a signal or recognition node and watch uptake move while the applicant and moral facts hold fixed. But wrongful conferral adds a further step. Once that recognition-response pathway is entrenched in a stable practice, the pathway helps generate a degraded standing rather than merely misrecognizing one. Only a coupled, typed structure registers both moments: the recognition is real and effective, and the standing stabilized by that pathway remains unwarranted.

7 Fields

A field tells the graph what counts. I use FIELD in a modest sense, for a normative practice or domain such as contract law, criminal law, medical ethics, ordinary promising, or friendship. In contract law it tells us which words, signatures, consideration, defects, and discharge agreements generate or defeat liability (American Law Institute, 1981, §§ 281, 285). In medicine it tells us who may consent, who may diagnose, which records count, and which responses follow. In friendship it tells us when a betrayal licenses resentment, apology, repair, or distrust.

The same surface event can receive different treatment across fields. Saying *I promise* at dinner may create an interpersonal obligation; saying the same words in a negotiation may be legally idle without the right form or consideration; saying them as part of a joke may create no obligation at all. A signature on a consent form may authorize treatment in a clinic, but a similar signature on a petition does not. The field supplies the relevant repertoire of statuses and the rules for moving among them.

Projectibility is field-relative in this sense. A status supports the projections licensed by the practice in which it figures. Breach in contract law projects toward liability, remedies, defenses, and excuses; breach in friendship projects toward resentment, apology, repair, and trust revision. Consent in medical ethics projects toward permission, disclosure duties, withdrawal conditions, and record-keeping.

Discriminatory standing projects toward lowered credibility, restricted options, sanction risk, anticipatory adjustment, and institutional routing. This is close to Boyd's accommodation thought: a practice-relative grouping earns its keep by helping the practice make the inferences it needs, not by having sharp boundaries independent of every practice (Boyd, 1999).

In Epstein's terms, each field has frame principles that fix grounding conditions for its status facts, and anchors that explain why those frame principles are in place (Epstein, 2015). Applied here, the field fixes which performances ground which statuses, which records preserve those statuses, which recognitions can alter those statuses, and which defeaters block those statuses.

Those conditions do not hang together by accident. Records, registers, monitoring, enforcement routines, reputational sanction, professional training, and habituated uptake help anchor and stabilize them. A field needn't itself be a natural kind or a further node in the network. For present purposes, stability means recurrence across cases, recognized routes for record or uptake, socially intelligible defeaters, and enough continuity that source nodes license defeasible expectations about target statuses and responses.

The parameter is therefore constrained. Not every useful redescription counts as a field, and not every labelled condition counts as a status. The framework misfires if the alleged field has no stabilized repertoire of moves, statuses, authorities or standing relations, record or uptake routes, and socially intelligible defeaters. It also misfires if the alleged status licenses no projections beyond the case at hand.

A one-off regularity, an analyst's convenient grouping, or a label that predicts nothing about recognition, response, constraint, enablement, validity, or defeat is not yet a causal-normative network. Nor may the field parameter be adjusted after the fact merely to save a preferred verdict: changing the field changes the projected routes and defeaters, and those changes must be supported by the practice's rules, records, uptake, or standing relations.

Field-validity is not the same as current recognition, enforceability, finality, or moral warrant. A contract can be valid even if a particular audience misses it; a release can terminate an obligation even if the promisee still demands performance; an unjust judgment can be procedurally valid while morally defective. The field fixes the validity conditions; recognition is one route by which agents track or fail to track those conditions.

Almäng (2016, pp. 6–8) makes the legal version explicit: institutional status, deontic relation, and institutional function can come apart, so status and the exercise of its normally attached function should be represented separately.

The typed network adds the route map: it shows when those separable elements are connected by status-determination, recognition, or causal uptake.

A limited analogy comes from assessment. Messick (1995) argues that validity attaches to supported interpretations and actions based on scores, not to an instrument considered in isolation. The present issue is practice-relative status validity, not measurement validity.

Communal cases need a further caution. In friendship, workplace standing, or discriminatory social position, there may be no office or rulebook that settles validity. The stricter question is whether the standing has been successfully conferred: whether agents with conferral standing in that context, operating through a recurring practice with recognizable uptake routes and defeaters, have imposed real constraints and enablements. Successful conferral can make the status socially real without giving the status moral warrant.

This also explains why fields can be fuzzy or contested without becoming useless. A counter-practice may reject an official rule without leaving the domain altogether. Oppressive and resistant uptake can coexist in the same workplace, clinic, court, or community. The question is whether the practice has enough recurrence, record or uptake routes, and socially intelligible defeaters to fix the status conditions relevant to the projection at issue.

This is why the field parameterizes the network rather than sitting inside it as another node. It fixes the repertoire of statuses, the performances that generate them, the authorities that may alter them, the records that preserve them, the recognitions that count, the responses that are licensed, and the defeats that block or end them.

Field-parameterization lets the account steer between universalism and relativism: one shared typed network, many field-specific parameterizations. I use *field* for a normative practice or domain, not in Bourdieu's technical sense. The paper needs only a modest point, not a general sociology of fields: status facts are assessed only relative to a practice whose status conditions are stabilized well enough to support projection.

Fields come in at least two kinds. Institutional fields assign status functions by authorized conferral; Searle (1995) builds these from the assignment of function, collective intentionality, and constitutive rules. A contract, diagnosis, judgment, or accepted resignation lives here, and so does authorized recognition. Speech-act practice also belongs here when an illocutionary act alters the deontic-modal position of participants (Sbisà, 2023).

Communal fields work differently. Ásta (2018) marks out statuses, gender and race among them, conferred by a community with conferral standing but no single office. That distinction explains why official judgment and discrimination, though both turn on recognition, behave so differently. The first is institutional: a recognition the field authorizes to make the status it records. The second is communal: a diffuse conferral with real constraints and enablements but no authorizing office, which is just why agents may have conferral standing while lacking moral authority to confer that status.

Behrensen (2018, pp. 42–43) uses the same contrast for nationality: legal nationality is conferred through administrative acts, while social nationality is a multipolar process with no central authority. The example supports the field contrast without making nationality the template for every communal conferral.

Ordinary promising and friendship are communal in this broad sense, though less regime-like than discriminatory standing. They lack a central office, but they still fix who can undertake, release, resent, apologize, repair, or defeat a claim well enough to support projection.

8 Conclusion

The paper began with cases in which a person is treated as occupying a status he does not have, or is assigned a standing that a practice successfully confers while morality rejects the standing. A causal graph can track the hounding, sanction, or exclusion, but not why the treatment fails to fit. A normative taxonomy can state the duty, permission, or standing, but not which social cascade that status will support. The forced choice between those two models was the opponent throughout.

Khalidi's causal-network account of kinds should be kept. Projection needs order, not concatenation. The moral and institutional cases show that the order can be carried by non-causal edges and still support projection. A causal-normative network is the typed structure, stabilized by field practices, that makes a status usable for inference.

A causal-normative network lets us project different things from the same assignment. From a release we project the lapse of obligation, even if demand continues. From a judgment we project records, enforceability, finality or preclusive effects, and remedial powers, while leaving truth and warrant open. From a discriminatory standing we project credibility loss, constrained options, sanction risk, institutional routing, and self-adjustment, while withholding moral warrant.

The framework does more than remind us that some explanations contain both causal and normative material. Its stronger claim concerns the shape of the projection profile. Separate explanations may remain true; the assignment's projection profile is still a mixed object. The profile becomes explicit when causal, recognitional, and status-determination routes are displayed together, with status-determination split between directed transitions and non-directed correlatives. That is why false recognition, wrongful institutional validity, wrongful communal conferral, and suppressed entitlement can be compared across fields. The model earns its keep by letting us compare without flattening and distinguish without isolating.

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